Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Monday, 26 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Light rain	Light rain	Rain	Light rain
17° 10°	16° 8°	15° 8°	16° 8°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **New revelations suggest Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, cut ties with her father after accusing him of abuse in a letter.**
Sources close to the Duchess claim she warned her father last year that he would never meet her children. This follows a long-running public dispute between them.
ROYALS · UK

2 **A man has been charged with murder after a body was discovered in a wheelie bin in a shocking incident.**
Police confirm that 36-year-old Mohamed Abotaka faces a murder charge in connection with the death of 52-year-old Ali Barzai. Investigations are ongoing.
CRIME · UK

3 **Labour could be exploring several ways to boost public funds in the upcoming Budget without increasing income tax.**
Chancellor John Healey might need to find extra money to improve his fiscal headroom. Experts are examining various options that could be on the table.
POLITICS · UK

4 **Students are embracing new tenancy freedoms, but landlords are warning of potential rent increases as a consequence.**
The Renters' Rights Act offers greater flexibility for students to leave tenancies. However, these changes are posing challenges for student landlords across the country.
HOUSING · UK

5 **Elon Musk's SpaceX reportedly restricted Ukraine's Starlink connection, accusing them of violating terms of service.**
The tech billionaire claims Ukraine used the network for military activity, leading to the restrictions. The service has since been restored.
TECHNOLOGY · INTERNATIONAL

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Huge congratulations to Raye, who has won this year's prestigious Mercury Prize for her album 'This Music May Contain Hope'.**

The pop sensation triumphed over a strong shortlist, including music legends like Paul McCartney. She takes home the £25,000 prize.

ON AIR — What's your favourite track from Raye's Mercury Prize-winning album?

MUSIC · TODAY

2 **Sam Fender has reportedly lowered ticket prices for his upcoming tour after previously speaking out about their cost.**

The Geordie singer has been vocal about making live music accessible. Fans will be pleased to hear tickets might be more affordable now.

ON AIR — Is it right for artists to intervene in ticket pricing, or should it be left to the promoters?

MUSIC · UPCOMING

3 **Irish DJ Jazzy, who has already amassed a billion streams, is set to drop her highly anticipated debut album.**

Having emerged from the vibrant Dublin club scene, Jazzy has collaborated with major artists like Calvin Harris. Her new album is expected to be a big hit.

ON AIR — Which new artist are you most excited about hearing a debut album from?

MUSIC · UPCOMING

4 **Strictly Come Dancing's new presenters, Josh Widdicombe, Emma Willis and Johannes Radebe, are reportedly settling into their roles.**

Initially, reviews were mixed, but critics now suggest the trio are finding their rhythm and getting into the groove. Fans are watching closely!

ON AIR — Who is your favourite new addition to a TV show this year?

TV · ONGOING

5 **London has a new mysterious caped figure helping people, leading many to wonder: who is the capital's real-life Batman?**

Some eagle-eyed observers are convinced it's YouTuber Niko Omilana in disguise. The internet is buzzing with theories and speculation!

ON AIR — If you could be a real-life superhero, what would your superpower be?

VIRAL · ONGOING

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Manchester United's Bruno Fernandes was left on the bench for their 3-0 defeat to Bournemouth, sparking questions about manager Michael Carrick's decision.**

The United skipper's absence follows his recent criticism of Carrick. This loss extends United's winless run to eight games, putting Carrick's future in doubt.

ON AIR — Was benching Fernandes a bold tactical move or a gamble that backfired spectacularly for Carrick?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Chelsea's Women's Super League team extended their unbeaten start to the season, coming from behind to beat Crystal Palace 3-1.**

Melvine Malard was the star of the show, scoring twice and winning a penalty. Chelsea now remain unbeaten in their first seven matches.

ON AIR — Who is your player to watch in the Women's Super League this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Marcus Smith marked his 200th appearance for Harlequins by inspiring them to their first Premiership win of the season against London rivals Saracens.**

Harlequins, who were bottom of the league, toppled Saracens 33-15. Smith's performance set the tone for a crucial victory.

ON AIR — What's the best sporting comeback you've ever witnessed?

RUGBY · UK

4 **England have made history by winning the Cerebral Palsy World Cup for the very first time, beating the United States in the final.**

Sam Dewhirst and David Porcher scored the decisive goals in Atlanta. It's a fantastic achievement for the team and a proud moment for English sport.

ON AIR — What's the most inspiring sporting victory you've heard about recently?

FOOTBALL · INTERNATIONAL

5 **Britain's Dalton Smith successfully defended his WBC light-welterweight world title in a split-decision victory over Alberto Puello.**

The fight took place in Sheffield, marking a triumphant homecoming for Smith. He retained his title in front of an ecstatic home crowd.

ON AIR — What's your favourite atmosphere at a live sporting event?

BOXING · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **A new trend sees people finding joy in the perfectly peeled orange.**
   Apparently, the satisfying spiral of a peel coming off in one piece is a small victory that brightens the day for many.

2. **Research suggests that simply watching a kettle boil can be surprisingly meditative.**
   The gentle sound and rising steam offer a moment of calm in busy routines, according to recent observations.

3. **Home bakers are discovering the secret comfort of a 'well-floured countertop'.**
   The soft, powdery feel and the promise of delicious treats create a simple, homely pleasure.

4. **Birdsong at dawn is being hailed as an unexpected mood booster for urban dwellers.**
   Even in the busiest cities, the early morning chorus offers a natural serenade that promotes wellbeing.

5. **The humble act of 'rescuing a stray sock' from the laundry basket is bringing quiet satisfaction.**
   Finding its partner, or simply giving it a temporary home, is a small, affirming moment for many.

6. **Enthusiasts are championing the serene beauty of 'frost on a garden gate' on a crisp morning.**
   The intricate patterns and glistening ice offer a fleeting, picturesque scene that's truly appreciated.

7. **There's a growing appreciation for the comforting weight of a 'favourite blanket' during cooler evenings.**
   Snuggling up with a familiar throw is a simple luxury that provides warmth and a sense of security.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new kind of fruit will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A GENTLE SQUEEZE TO TEST ITS RIPENESS!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of tea, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: ARRANGING THE BISCUITS ON THE SAUCER JUST SO, EVEN IF THEY'RE ONLY FOR DIPPING!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday item' just looks so aesthetically pleasing – maybe the way a set of pencils are arranged, or a stack of books, or even the neatly organised shelves in a shop?**
  What everyday item, in your opinion, looks surprisingly beautiful when it's just 'right'?

- **We all have that 'one particular window' in our home that we just love looking out of, don't we? It might have a great view, or just catch the light in a special way, or perhaps you've got a bird feeder outside it.**
  Which window in your house is your favourite, and what makes looking out of it so special?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** The 'puffin' can hold several fish in its beak at once, often more than ten, thanks to a special arrangement of spines on its tongue and upper palate.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Squirrels are known to bury nuts in a precise, geometric pattern to help them remember where they've stored their winter provisions.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public railway opened in England in 1825, running from Shildon to Stockton.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwllllantysiliogogogoch, in Wales.
- Lemons contain more sugar than strawberries.
- The distinctive red telephone boxes in the UK were designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The 'Big Ben' clock tower in London is officially called Elizabeth Tower.
- A snail can sleep for three years.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES MON 26 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 299 of the year, 66 days left in 2026. Today Accession Day (Jammu and Kashmir, India); Angam Day (Nauru); Armed Forces Day (Benin); Christian feast day: Alfred the Great (Catholic Church, Anglican Church, Eastern Orthodox Church). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Jon Heder, American actor and producer
- 1973 — Austin Healey, English rugby player and sportscaster
- 1936 — Al Casey, American guitarist (died 2006)
- 1978 — Jimmy Aggrey, English footballer and actor
- 1971 — Anthony Rapp, American actor and singer
- 1980 — Claire Cooper, English actress
- 1954 — James Pickens Jr., American actor
- 1936 — Shelley Morrison, American actress (died 2019)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1977 — Ali Maow Maalin, the last natural case of smallpox, develops a rash in Somalia. The WHO and the CDC consider this date to be the anniversary of the eradication of smallpox, the most spectacular success of vaccination.
- 1944 — World War II: The Battle of Leyte Gulf ends with an overwhelming American victory.
- 1995 — Mossad agents assassinate Palestinian Islamic Jihad leader Fathi Shaqaqi in his hotel in Malta.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: The Battle of Leyte Gulf ends with an overwhelming American victory.
- 1994 — Jordan and Israel sign a peace treaty.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1985 — The Australian government returns ownership of Uluru to the local Pitjantjatjara Aboriginals.
- 1991 — Three months after the end of the Ten-Day War, the last soldier of the Yugoslav People's Army leaves the territory of the Republic of Slovenia.

- 1995 — Mossad agents assassinate Palestinian Islamic Jihad leader Fathi Shaqaqi in his hotel in Malta.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES TUE 27 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 300 of the year, 65 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abbán; Christian feast day: Abraham the Poor; Christian feast day: Gaudiosus of Naples; Christian feast day: Kaleb of Axum. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Jonathan Stroud, English author
- 1972 — Evan Coyne Maloney, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1958 — David Hazeltine, American pianist and composer
- 1958 — Simon Le Bon, English singer-songwriter
- 1968 — Vinny Samways, English footballer and manager
- 1943 — Carmen Argenziano, American actor and producer (died 2019)
- 1963 — Marla Maples, American model and actress
- 1984 — Kelly Osbourne, English television personality

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1979 — Saint Vincent and the Grenadines gains its independence from the United Kingdom.
- 1980 — The Chun Doo-hwan government forcibly arrests and investigates monks and personnel of the Jogye Order.
- 1958 — Iskander Mirza, the first President of Pakistan, is deposed by General Ayub Khan, who had been appointed the enforcer of martial law by Mirza 20 days earlier.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1999 — Gunmen open fire in the Armenian Parliament, killing the Prime Minister and seven others.
- 1993 — Widerøe Flight 744 crashes in Overhalla Municipality, Norway, killing six people.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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